Harbor

Brand book and product guide

Voice, colour, type, wording, product facts, warranty, policies and terms.
Version 7, October 2026. For staff, agencies, printers and retail partners.

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brand@harbor.example · Internal and partner use only.

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This book replaces version 6 (February 2025). Where an older document disagrees with this one, this one wins. Questions go to the brand lead at brand@harbor.example.

How to use this book

- Copywriters and agencies: read pages 5 to 7 and page 10 before writing anything.
- Designers and printers: pages 8 to 10 are your rules. Colour values and sizes are exact.
- Customer care and retail partners: pages 11 to 14 are the facts and terms we stand behind.
- If a claim is not on the product pages (page 11), it is not a claim. Do not make it.

WHO WE ARE

Brand description

Harbor makes insulated steel bottles and mugs for people who hike at the weekend and commute in the week. We sell through our own online shop, outdoor retailers in the UK and Ireland, and a small number of independent coffee shops that stock the Harbor Mug.

We started on a cold shore with one steel bottle and a promise: what you fill at dawn is still cold at dusk. We still test every new bottle on the same stretch of coast before it goes on sale. We are a team of 22 people in Bristol.

> *“Fill it once. Built for long days outside.”*

What we make

- **Flask Trail 750:** our main bottle, 750 ml. The new Tidal colourway launches in six weeks.
- **Flask Trail 500:** the smaller bottle, 500 ml, for commutes and short walks.
- **Harbor Mug:** a 350 ml mug with a sliding lid, for the desk and the car.
- **Spare parts:** lids, seals and carry loops, so a bottle lasts.

Who we make it for

Our customer is outside before work or after it: a weekend hiker, a cyclist commuter, a dog walker at dawn. They want a bottle that does what it says, every day, without fuss. They read the label. They notice when a brand overclaims, and they do not come back.

What makes us different

- We say exactly what the bottle does and stop there. Our facts are tested on the shore, not in a brochure.
- We design for repair: every lid and seal is sold separately.
- We are quiet. No shouting, no exclamation marks, no promises the product sheet does not make.

VISION, MISSION AND GOALS

Where we are going

Vision

> *A bottle you trust on every long day outside.*

Trust is the whole idea. A bottle that keeps drinks cold for 24 hours, every time, and a brand that never says more than that.

Mission

To make insulated bottles that do exactly what we say, last for years, and can be repaired when a part wears out.

Values

Value	What it means	What it looks like
Calm	We do not shout.	No exclamation marks, no emoji, no hype words.
Factual	We say what the product does.	Every claim is on the product sheet, with a number.
Outdoors	We are made for weather.	Real light, real rain, real shore in every picture.
Lasting	A bottle should outlast its owner's boots.	5-year warranty. Every part sold separately.

Goals for 2027

Goal	Measure	Target
Launch Tidal well	Tidal units sold in the first 90 days	8,000
Keep the promise	Warranty claims per 1,000 bottles	Under 4
Repair, not replace	Spare-part orders as a share of all orders	12%
Be easy to deal with	Customer care first reply	Under 1 working day
Grow retail	Outdoor retail partners	120 (from 85)

The long day outside

Everything Harbor makes comes back to one theme: **the long day outside**. Fill the bottle at dawn on the shore. Carry it up the trail, onto the train, into the office, back out at dusk. Still cold. Our name is the place you start from and come back to.

Theme in practice

- Settings are shores, trails, platforms and desks by a window. Weather is part of the picture.
- Light is real: dawn, dusk, mist, rain. Never studio white.
- The bottle is always in use or just put down. Never floating in white space.
- No people's faces. Hands are fine: a hand on the lid, a bottle in a pack pocket.

Personality

If Harbor were a person, they would be the friend who has already checked the tide times, packed a spare layer, and says very little on the walk because the view says enough.

We are	We are not
Calm	Loud, breathless or excitable
Factual	Vague, poetic or exaggerated
Outdoorsy	Extreme, macho or adrenaline-fuelled
Quietly confident	Boastful or competitive
Plain-spoken	Technical, corporate or jargon-heavy
Lasting	Disposable, trendy or seasonal

Taglines in use

- “Fill it once.” (primary)
- “Built for long days outside.” (product)
- “Cold at dawn. Cold at dusk.” (Flask Trail 750)

VOICE AND TONE

How Harbor sounds

Our voice is **calm, factual, outdoors**. Short words, short sentences. We describe what the product does and we stop there. We do not shout. We do not use exclamation marks or emoji.

Five voice rules

- **Say what it does.** “Keeps drinks cold for 24 hours”, not “insanely cold all day”.
- **Stop there.** One fact per line. No second adjective.
- **Use a number when you have one.** 24 hours, 750 ml, 5 years.
- **Never promise beyond the sheet.** If page 11 does not say it, we do not say it.
- **Stay calm.** No exclamation marks, no emoji, no capitals for emphasis.

Tone by situation

Situation	Tone	Example
Poster or social	Calm, a little poetic	Cold at dawn. Cold at dusk.
Product page	Plain and exact	750 ml. Cold for 24 hours, hot for 12. Lid hand-wash only.
Order emails	Brief and warm	Your bottle is packed and on its way.
Customer complaint	Serious, direct	That should not have happened. Here is what we will do.
Legal and policy	Precise	The warranty covers manufacturing faults for 5 years.

Before and after

Not like this	Like this
The ultimate eco-friendly bottle that keeps drinks icy forever!	Keeps drinks cold for 24 hours. Plastic-free body.
Totally dishwasher-safe, so cleaning is a breeze!	The body is dishwasher-safe. The lid is hand-wash only.
Unbreakable. Guaranteed for life.	Steel body. 5-year warranty.

WORDING

Words we use and words we never use

Words we use

Shore, dawn, dusk, cold, steel, long day, pack, trail, tide. We say “keeps drinks cold for 24 hours”. We say “built for long days outside”. We say “fill it once”.

Words we never use

These words and claims must never appear in any Harbor copy, in any channel:

- **Eco-friendly** and **sustainable**. We cannot prove either, so we do not say either.
- **Unbreakable.** Steel dents. Glass breaks. Nothing is unbreakable.
- **Lifetime guarantee.** Our warranty is 5 years. Say 5 years.
- **Cold forever.** Cold for 24 hours is the claim.
- **Fully dishwasher-safe.** The body is. The lid is hand-wash only.
- **Any claim about recycling, carbon or certifications.** We hold none, so we claim none.

Claims we can make

Claim	Where it comes from
Keeps drinks cold for 24 hours, hot for 12 (Flask Trail 750)	Product sheet, shore-tested
The body is dishwasher-safe; the lid is hand-wash only	Product sheet
Leak-proof lid	Product sheet, tested upside down in a pack for 8 hours
Plastic-free body	Product sheet: steel inside and out
5-year warranty	Warranty terms, page 12

Spelling and style

- British English: colour, colourway, litre.
- Our name is “Harbor”. Never “HARBOR”, “Harbor Bottles” or “Harbour”.
- Product names as written: Flask Trail 750, Flask Trail 500, Harbor Mug, Tidal.
- Volumes as “750 ml” with a space. Times as “24 hours”, never “24h” in copy.
- No exclamation marks. No emoji. No words in capitals for emphasis.

COLOUR

Navy, sand and sea glass

Three colours, taken from the shore at dawn: deep water, dry sand, and the green of worn sea glass. Use the hex values exactly. Never use a gradient.

Brand colours

Navy #1F3A5F
Our ground.
Backgrounds, the wordmark on sand, the Tidal body. RGB 31 58 95.

Sand #EFE6D8
Our light.
Backgrounds on dark sites, the plate behind the logo, text on navy. RGB 239 230 216.

Sea glass #A8D5BA
Small accents only.
A rule, an icon, the Tidal lid. Never behind text. RGB 168 213 186.

Supporting neutrals

Ink #14202E
Text on sand.
Body copy on light backgrounds. RGB 20 32 46.

Mist #C9D1D9
Lines.
Dividers and table rules. Never a background. RGB 201 209 217.

Rules

- Use the navy ground unless the placement is on a dark site; then use sand.
- Sea glass covers no more than 5% of a layout and never sits behind text.
- Never use a gradient, a tint of navy, or a fourth brand colour.
- Text pairings: sand on navy, navy on sand, ink on sand.
- In photography and image prompts, describe navy water, sand and sea glass tones in soft natural light.

TYPOGRAPHY AND LOGO

Type and the wordmark

Headlines in Archivo Semibold. Body in Source Sans. Both are free under the SIL Open Font License.

Font families

Family	Role	Weights	Fallback
Archivo	Headlines, product names on packaging	SemiBold 600 only	Helvetica, Arial
Source Sans 3	Body copy, UI, labels, legal text	Regular 400, SemiBold 600	Helvetica, Arial

Copy limits

Element	Limit
Headline	Never longer than six words
Subheadline	Never longer than twelve words
Body on a poster	Never longer than twenty-five words
YouTube thumbnail headline	No more than four words
48-sheet	Six words maximum on the whole sheet

The logo

- The Harbor wordmark sits bottom-right on every poster.
- Clear space equal to the height of the H on all sides.
- Never on a photo without the sand plate behind it.
- Never rotated, recoloured, outlined or given a shadow.
- Never smaller than 24 mm on an A3 poster.

Setting type

- Headlines in sentence case. Left-aligned, except on the 48-sheet.
- Never set body text in Archivo, and never set anything in all capitals.
- On posters, no more than three type sizes in total.

PHOTOGRAPHY AND POSTERS

Pictures, words and placements

Photography

- Real light, real weather. Dawn and dusk. Mist, rain, cold water.
- The bottle is always in use or just put down, never floating in white space.
- No people's faces. Hands are fine.
- Colour grade toward navy water, sand and sea glass. No heavy filters.

Pictures and words

The picture never contains words. Headlines, subheadlines and body text are set in type over the picture by the layout, never painted into the image. Image prompts describe the scene only.

Placements

Placement	Size	Notes
A3 poster	297 × 420 mm, 3 mm bleed	Headline top third. Logo bottom-right.
6-sheet	1200 × 1800 mm	Headline must read from 10 m. Minimum type 120 pt.
48-sheet	6096 × 3048 mm	Six words maximum. Logo right.
Instagram square	1080 × 1080 px	Keep 120 px clear at the bottom for the caption bar.
Instagram story	1080 × 1920 px	Top 250 px and bottom 300 px free of text.
Facebook feed / LinkedIn	1200 × 628 px	Headline left, bottle right.
YouTube thumbnail	1280 × 720 px	Headline no more than four words.
Email header	600 × 200 px	One line. No body text.
Web hero	1920 × 800 px	Headline left third. Bottle right third.

Print files go as PDF/X-4 in CMYK at 300 dpi; screen files as PNG.

PRODUCTS AND FACTS

The range

These are the only product facts copy may use. If it is not here, it is not a claim.

Product	Size	Cold / hot	Care	Price
Flask Trail 750	750 ml	24 hours / 12 hours	Body dishwasher-safe. Lid hand-wash only.	£34.00
Flask Trail 500	500 ml	18 hours / 8 hours	Same body and lid rules as the 750.	£28.00
Harbor Mug	350 ml, sliding lid	6 hours / 4 hours	Dishwasher-safe, lid included.	£22.00

Flask Trail 750: our main bottle

- 750 ml insulated steel bottle.
- Keeps drinks cold for 24 hours and hot for 12 hours.
- The body is dishwasher-safe. The lid is hand-wash only.
- The lid is leak-proof.
- Plastic-free body.
- Warranty: 5 years.

Tidal: the new colourway

Tidal is the new Flask Trail 750 colourway: navy with sea glass. It launches in six weeks. **The Tidal launch is embargoed until launch day.** No poster, post or press line about Tidal goes out before then. Pre-orders open one week before launch.

Caring for your bottle

- Put the body in the dishwasher if you like. Wash the lid by hand in warm soapy water.
- Do not soak the lid or put it in the dishwasher: heat damages the seal and it stops being leak-proof.
- Do not freeze the bottle or put it in a microwave.
- Replace the seal every two years, or sooner if it no longer closes tight. Seals are sold separately.

WARRANTY

The 5-year warranty

Every Harbor bottle and mug comes with a 5-year warranty on top of your legal rights. This warranty does not affect your statutory rights under the Consumer Rights Act 2015.

What is covered

Product	Period	Covers
Flask Trail 750 and 500	5 years from delivery	Loss of insulation, faulty welds, a lid thread that fails
Harbor Mug	5 years from delivery	Loss of insulation, faulty welds, a sliding lid that fails
Spare lids and seals	1 year from delivery	Manufacturing faults

If a covered fault appears in normal use, we repair the bottle, replace the faulty part, or replace the bottle. If none of those is possible, we refund it.

What is not covered

- Dents, scratches and worn paint from normal use. We think they give a bottle character.
- A lid damaged in the dishwasher. The lid is hand-wash only.
- Seals that wear out with use. They are a spare part, sold separately.
- Freezing, microwaving, or carbonated or hot drinks above 95 degrees in a closed bottle.
- Commercial use, and bottles changed or repaired by anyone other than Harbor.

How to claim

- Email care@harbor.example with your order number, a short description and a photo of the fault.
- We reply within 1 working day, and send a free returns label if we need to see the bottle.
- We repair, replace or refund within 10 working days of receiving it.
- A repaired or replaced bottle keeps the rest of the original warranty, or 90 days, whichever is longer.

Damaged on arrival

If a bottle arrives dented or broken, tell us within 14 days with a photo. We send a new one straight away; you do not need to return the damaged one.

POLICIES

Delivery, returns and more

Delivery

Service	Time	Cost
UK standard	2 to 3 working days after dispatch	£3.95, free over £40
UK express	Next working day if ordered by 13:00	£6.95
Republic of Ireland	3 to 5 working days	£7.95
EU	4 to 8 working days	From £9.95, duties may apply

Returns and refunds

- Unused products in their original packaging can be returned within 30 days of delivery for a full refund.
- Used bottles can be returned only if faulty; see the warranty on page 12.
- Refunds go to the original payment method within 5 working days of receiving the return.
- Return postage is paid by you, unless the item is faulty or we sent the wrong thing.

Pre-orders

- Pre-orders for a new colourway open one week before launch, never earlier.
- We charge when the order ships, not when you pre-order. You can cancel any time before it ships.

Materials

The bottle body is steel inside and out, so it is plastic-free. The lid contains a food-safe silicone seal. We do not make claims about recycling, carbon or certifications, and do not hold any certifications to claim.

Privacy (summary)

We collect only what we need to take and deliver your order. We never sell your data. Marketing email is opt-in only, with a one-click unsubscribe. The full notice is at harbor.example/privacy.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

Terms of sale

1. Who we are. These terms apply to sales by Harbor Outdoor Ltd, a company registered in England and Wales (company number 10457731), registered office 12 Wapping Wharf, Bristol BS1 6WP. VAT number GB 274 1189 30.

2. Your order. When you place an order we email to acknowledge it. The contract is formed when we email to confirm dispatch. We may decline an order, for example if an item is out of stock, and refund you in full.

3. Prices and payment. Prices are in pounds sterling and include VAT. Delivery is charged as shown at checkout. We take payment when you place the order, except for pre-orders, which are charged on dispatch.

4. Delivery. Delivery times on page 13 are estimates. Risk passes to you on delivery. If delivery is more than 30 days late you may cancel and get a full refund.

5. Your right to cancel. Under the Consumer Contracts Regulations 2013 you may cancel within 14 days of delivery. Our own returns policy gives you 30 days for unused products.

6. Faulty goods. If goods are faulty you have rights under the Consumer Rights Act 2015, including a refund within 30 days of delivery and repair or replacement after that. Our 5-year warranty is in addition to these rights.

7. Product information. We describe our products accurately. Insulation times are measured at 20 degrees room temperature with the lid closed, filled to the top. Real use varies.

8. Promotions. Discount codes are single use unless stated and cannot be exchanged for cash or combined unless stated. We will honour orders already placed if a promotion ends.

9. Our liability. We are responsible for foreseeable loss or damage caused by our breach of these terms. We do not exclude liability for death or personal injury caused by our negligence, or for fraud. We are not liable for business losses; our products are for personal use.

10. Events outside our control. We are not responsible for delays caused by events outside our reasonable control. If such an event lasts more than 30 days you may cancel and receive a refund for goods not delivered.

11. Changes to these terms. We may update these terms. The version in force when you order applies to that order.

12. Law and disputes. These terms are governed by the law of England and Wales. You may bring proceedings in the courts of England and Wales, or of Scotland or Northern Ireland if you live there. Contact us first at care@harbor.example; we answer every complaint within 5 working days.

APPROVALS AND CONTACTS

Who signs off, and how to reach us

Approvals

Every poster is approved by the brand lead before it goes to print or to a channel. Send the spec, the picture and the placement name. Allow two working days.

What	Who approves	Turnaround
Posters, ads and social posts	Brand lead	2 working days
Anything about Tidal before launch day	Nobody: it is embargoed	Not before launch
New product claims	Brand lead and head of product	5 working days
Packaging and print	Brand lead and production	10 working days
Retail partner co-branding	Founders	10 working days

Contacts

Team	Email	For
Brand lead	brand@harbor.example	This book, artwork, approvals
Print	production@harbor.example	Print files, proofs, placements
Customer care	care@harbor.example	Orders, returns, warranty claims
Retail	trade@harbor.example	Retail accounts and stock
Press	press@harbor.example	Media requests and images

Quick checklist before anything goes out

- Calm, factual, outdoors? No exclamation marks, no emoji?
- Every claim on page 11? Nothing eco-friendly, sustainable, unbreakable or fully dishwasher-safe?
- Nothing about Tidal before launch day?
- Headline six words or fewer, subheadline twelve, body twenty-five, no words in the picture?
- Navy ground, sea glass only as an accent, no gradient, logo bottom-right on its sand plate?
- Approved by the brand lead?